

KAMBOJ'S MULTI-PURPOSE FOOD PROCESSING MACHINE WILL HELP CUT DOWN THE COLOSSAL WASTAGE IN THE AGRICULTURAL SUPPLY CHAIN OF THE COUNTRY.

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nate the problem in the second prototype either. In the third one, he introduced a castor oil bath, which could maintain the temperature till 200°C. He then modified it to make it easily transportable, including making the legs foldable. It was in 2007 that he completed the innovation in the fourth prototype by incorporating a sieve to manage the flow of herb extracts. The multi-purpose processor is capable of pulverising and extracting oil/gel from various herbs.

It comprises a vertical cylindrical unit mounted on four legs. The raw material is fed from the top and the processed output can be collected at the bottom. The unit can process 100 kg of aloe vera in an hour. About 1.25 kg of aloe vera leaves are converted to one litre of gel in the unit.

Kamboj, who lives with his wife and children on the outskirts of the village near his two acre of land, recalls how neighbours would often laugh at him, calling him insane. He gives the

credit for his achievements to his mother who instilled in him the urge to know more about herbs and to his own family for their support when he decided to start his own enterprise of agro foods and organic farming. "My wife always motivated me in difficult times. She was apprehensive in the beginning, worrying about meeting the expenses of education and innovation. But she single-handedly looked after the family so that I could continue to pursue the innovations," says Kamboj. His daughter Pooja, doing her masters in business administration, and son, studying computer engineering, help him on technical aspects, adds a proud Kamboj.

In 2008, Kamboj got Rs 2.8 lakh as funding under the HDFC revolving fund to manufacture and sell a few units. He has sold 12 units in Haryana and Meerut, Chandigarh, Dholakua in Gujarat, Bilaspur and Jaipur under the brand name, Prince at Rs 1.2 lakh a piece. With his order books full from Visakhapatnam in Andhra Pradesh, Pilani in Rajasthan, Panipat in Haryana and Chandigarh, Kamboj has given employment to over two dozen women in his manufacturing set-up. For him, it's a fruity success. ■

